



Regardless of whether it's a household, an oathcircle, or a motley, however, there are some basic questions that a group should at least consider before the chronicle begins. Even if they won't be answered right away, it's good to have them in mind as the story unfolds.

Where does the motley get together?

Is there a specific place that the group tends to gather? Is it a mortal spot, a changeling freehold, or a realm in the Dreaming? Is it a private spot, or is it known to outsiders? Does the motley generally stay in one place, or do they travel on a regular basis? If so, what do they do to support themselves on the road? How do the characters justify getting together to the people in their mortal lives, or do they just leave it a mystery and hope no one investigates?

Does the motley have a freehold?

A magical base of operations is not just a wonderful place to help bring the chronicle to life, it's also a source of nearly endless story hooks. Do the characters own or run the freehold? If so, how do they hold onto it, particularly if it's a powerful site? If not, who controls it, and what are relations like between the owner and the motley? Where is the freehold located? What does it look like in the mortal world, and how does it appear to the fae?

What are the motley's goals?

While some motleys may just be groups of friends who hang out simply because they're friends, the nature of the Dreaming often leads to quests and oaths that can bestow a higher purpose on a group, and some motleys come together in the first place precisely because of such obligations. Even a group with no "official" goal or quest often has a purpose of some kind, even if it's as simple as "have fun" or "go on the best road trip ever." Does the motley have any stated goals? Unstated ones? Are there any oaths or bans directing them? If so, what are they?

Who are the motley's enemies?

A motley's enemies help define it as much as its allies do, if not moreso. Who has it in for the group, and why? Does the group know about this animosity, or is it going to surprise them when it finally boils over? Is it a vindictive noble, rival commoner, a marauding chimera, a terrifying Dauntain, or a mysterious Prodigal? Remember that enemies don't have to be "evil" in a purely villainous sense — a concerned mortal parent who's worried about her teenage wilder son staying out all night and hanging with the wrong crowd can cause a lot of serious headaches for a motley without starting a single battle or casting any magic spells.

Who are the motley's allies?

Even the most nomadic group of rootless loners makes connections, sometimes despite themselves. Who does the motley turn to when they need information? A favor? A place to lie low? Who can they count on, and why do they trust them? And if they don't trust them, what is it that keeps the relationship between them productive?